

So why isn't everyone moving down there? No jobs. Young people I talked to told me they would prefer to stay put. But those who take their careers seriously move to Washington, D.C., Atlanta, or Chicago. They intend to return, but few actually do. The result is low demand for housing back home.

When you retire at age 35 you reverse the migration. Cash out of your home up North, put the money in the bank, and head for a small town in the South that offers few jobs. Rent or buy a \$20,000 to \$40,000 house and you're set to start your new life.

Why not plan to visit some of these places next summer? If you don't like the South, try Vermont, Washington, or Montana. Look for places where you can:

Live where the jobs aren't

Once you move to your low-cost living space in the United States, you can think about living part of the year overseas. Think about it long enough and you may say good-bye to your U.S. housing costs altogether. You'll stick your furniture in someone's basement and head for the beaches of Yugoslavia, the cool plateaus of Mexico, or the tropical warmth of Thailand.

WHY IT'S ALWAYS CHEAP IN THE THIRD WORLD

One day after a major devaluation in Argentina, I went to buy a dozen eggs, bread, milk, and a stick of butter. Because the maid usually did the shopping, I was out of touch with prices. Even so, I was in for a surprise at the checkout stand. The total came to 85 cents.

Prices in Argentina didn't stay that low for very long. But even in 1987, during a so-called "high cost" period, two adults could live well in Buenos Aires on \$900 a month, including housing. Two adults living on \$50 a day could live in the upper middle class.